

Workbook 11: Emotional Wellness Plan

Related article: The Emotional Side of Hearing Loss

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Workbook: My Emotional Wellness and Hearing Plan

Part 1: How hearing loss affects me emotionally

Check any statements that feel true.

- ☐ I feel frustrated when I miss words.
- ☐ I feel embarrassed when I misunderstand.
- ☐ I feel tired after listening for a long time.
- ☐ I avoid noisy places.
- ☐ I avoid group conversations.
- ☐ I feel left out sometimes.
- ☐ I worry people think I am not listening.
- ☐ I feel anxious before social events.
- ☐ I feel less confident than I used to.
- ☐ I feel sad about changes in my hearing.
- ☐ I get irritated when people speak from another room.
- ☐ I pretend to understand sometimes.
- ☐ I feel overwhelmed by hearing aids or hearing technology.

The hardest emotional part of hearing loss for me is:

Part 2: My listening fatigue signs

When listening becomes tiring, I notice:

- ☐ I feel mentally tired
- ☐ I get irritated more easily
- ☐ I stop participating
- ☐ I need quiet time
- ☐ I get headaches
- ☐ I miss more information

- I feel stressed
- I avoid conversation
- I rely on others to explain
- I pretend to understand

One sign that I need a listening break is:

Part 3: Situations I avoid

Check any situations you avoid because hearing is difficult.

- Restaurants
- Family gatherings
- Parties
- Work meetings
- Phone calls
- Video calls
- Religious or community events
- Medical appointments
- Group conversations
- Public places
- Conversations with unfamiliar people
- Other: _____

One situation I want to participate in more confidently is:

A support or strategy that may help is:

Part 4: My support system

People who can support me include:

- Audiologist
- Primary care provider
- Ear, nose, and throat specialist
- Spouse or partner
- Children

- Grandchildren
- Friends
- Coworkers
- Caregiver
- Counselor or mental health provider
- Support group
- Other: _____

One person I can talk to about my hearing is:

One thing I want them to understand is:

Part 5: Self-advocacy phrases

Practice phrases that may reduce stress.

- “Please face me when you speak.”
- “I heard part of that, but I missed the last sentence.”
- “Can you say that another way?”
- “Can we move somewhere quieter?”
- “Please do not speak from another room.”
- “Can you write that down?”
- “I want to be included, but I need one person to speak at a time.”
- “Let me repeat that back to make sure I understood.”
- “I need a short listening break.”

My own phrase:

Part 6: My emotional wellness plan

One hearing-related situation I want to improve is:

One communication strategy I will try is:

One technology or tool I want to ask about is:

One person I will ask for support is:

One question I want to ask my audiologist is:

One question I want to ask my healthcare provider or counselor is: